VIT Bhopal University

CSE0001 – Digital Literacy

Digital Literacy Portfolio – Project Report

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Introduction

This report documents my work as part of the CSE0001 Digital Literacy course at VIT Bhopal University. As a Student Digital Ambassador, I was assigned to build a Digital Literacy Portfolio that demonstrates my understanding of essential digital skills required in today's technology-driven world.

The project is divided into five tasks, each aligned to a specific module of the course. These tasks cover creating a digital literacy infographic, building a professional online portfolio, exploring coding and collaboration platforms, practising email etiquette, and researching cybercrime awareness. All deliverables are organized in a single GitHub repository, which itself serves as a key part of the submission.

No prior coding experience was required, and all tools used in this project are free and browser-based. This project helped me understand the importance of maintaining a safe, responsible, and professional presence in the digital world.

Task 1 – Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

Tool Used

I used Canva (canva.com) to create the infographic. Canva is a free, browser-based graphic design tool that provides a wide range of professional templates suitable for educational visuals.

What My Design Shows

My infographic is titled 'Digital Literacy – What Every Student Must Know and covers the following three topics:

- What Digital Literacy is: The ability to use digital tools and the internet effectively, safely, and responsibly.
- Safe Internet Practices: Using strong passwords, enabling two-factor authentication, and avoiding suspicious links.
- Professional Online Presence: The importance of maintaining clean social media profiles and building a portfolio on platforms like GitHub and LinkedIn.

Reflection

I used Canva because it allowed me to create a visually appealing design without any prior graphic design experience. I found it slightly difficult to choose a colour scheme that looked professional rather than childish. However, experimenting with Canva's built-in palettes helped me settle on a clean blue-and-white theme. The most interesting part was realising how much a well-designed visual can communicate in a single glance compared to a paragraph of text.

Task 2 – Student Digital Portfolio

Platforms Set Up

For this task, I created and updated accounts on three platforms: GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle.

- GitHub (github.com): A platform used by developers to host code, collaborate on projects, and showcase their programming work. I created a profile README with my name, branch, year, and a statement about what I hope to learn over the next five years.
- LinkedIn (linkedin.com): A professional networking platform used by working professionals, recruiters, and students. I filled in my Education section with my current degree, institution (VIT Bhopal University), and expected graduation year (2030).
- Kaggle (kaggle.com): A data science community platform where students and professionals compete in machine learning challenges and access datasets. I created an account and set up a basic profile.

Future Plans

Over the next four years, I plan to use GitHub to upload all my coding assignments and personal projects so that internship recruiters can review my work. I will use LinkedIn to connect with seniors, faculty, and industry professionals and keep track of internship opportunities. Kaggle will be useful once I begin learning data science and machine learning in my later semesters, where I can practise with real-world datasets and participate in beginner competitions.

Task 3 – Coding & Collaboration Platforms

Part A – Coding Practice (HackerRank)

I created an account on HackerRank (hackerrank.com) and completed the beginner-level challenge titled 'Solve Me First'. The challenge required me to write a function that takes two integers as input and returns their sum. I solved it using C++ by returning the sum of the two parameters inside the function. The solution was accepted on the first attempt and I received a completion badge.

Part B – Google Forms Quiz

I created a Google Form titled 'Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz' containing five questions designed to test basic digital literacy knowledge among first-year students.

Reflection

HackerRank helped me understand that competitive coding does not have to be intimidating — even a simple addition problem is a valid starting point. Building the Google Form made me think carefully about how to phrase questions clearly and neutrally. Both tools are directly relevant to my academic journey: HackerRank for sharpening programming skills and Google Forms for conducting surveys, feedback collection, and quizzes as part of group projects.

Task 4 – Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

Email 1 – Assignment Extension Request

Email 2 – Internship Interest

Communication Scenario & Key Learnings

A student once complained about a professor using their full name on Twitter after receiving a poor grade. The tweet went viral, reached the college administration, and the student faced disciplinary action. If the student had raised their concern directly through email or the college grievance portal, the issue could have been resolved privately and professionally. This incident highlights that digital communication has permanent consequences — what is posted online cannot be fully erased. The key learning from this task is that professional tone, proper structure, and choosing the right channel of communication are as important as the content of the message itself.

Task 5 – Cybercrime Awareness Case Study

Case Study: Cyberbullying

Priya, an 18-year-old first-year B.Tech student in Indore, gave a wrong answer during an online Google Meet class. A classmate, Rohan, took a screenshot of her confused expression without her consent and shared it in the 60-member class WhatsApp group with a mocking caption. Within hours, the image spread to other groups, memes were created, and Priya became the target of widespread online ridicule. She was excluded from study groups and began skipping online classes out of fear and embarrassment.

Cyberbullying typically targets students who are new, introverted, or publicly make mistakes. The consequences in this case were severe: Priya developed anxiety, her academic performance dropped, and she required professional counselling. The college's Internal Complaints Committee eventually issued a formal warning to Rohan, but the screenshots continued to circulate online long after the incident was considered resolved.

Rohan's actions were unethical and potentially illegal under Section 66A and Section 67 of the IT Act, 2000. Classmates who forwarded the content were equally responsible. The incident should have been reported immediately at cybercrime.gov.in or by calling the National Cyber Crime Helpline at 1930.

Reflection

What surprised me most while researching this topic was that cyberbullying can happen so quickly and casually — what begins as a single screenshot in a group chat can escalate into a full-scale harassment campaign within hours. I had assumed that cyberbullying was mostly something that happened to school students, but this research showed me that college students are equally vulnerable, especially in the first year when they are new and have not yet built a strong social network.

One habit I will personally change as a result of this task is to never forward or react to mocking content in any group chat, even if it seems harmless or funny. I now understand that every forward and every laughing emoji counts as participation in the bullying. I will also make a point to privately support anyone I see being targeted online rather than staying silent.

Conclusion

This project gave me a comprehensive and practical introduction to the key pillars of digital literacy. Through five structured tasks, I learned how to create professional visual content, build an online portfolio, use coding and collaboration tools, communicate professionally via email, and understand the real-world dangers of cybercrime. Each task required me to engage with real tools that I will continue to use throughout my academic and professional journey.

The most valuable insight from this project is that being digitally literate is not just about knowing how to use technology — it is about using it responsibly, professionally, and safely. I feel significantly more prepared to navigate the digital world as a student and as a future professional.

References

- Canva – Free Design Tool. https://canva.com
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- Kaggle – Data Science Community. https://kaggle.com
- HackerRank – Coding Practice Platform. https://hackerrank.com
- Google Forms – Survey Tool. https://forms.google.com
- National Cyber Crime Portal – https://cybercrime.gov.in
- IT Act, 2000 – Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology, Government of India
- VITyarthi E-Learning Platform – CSE0001 Digital Literacy Course Material